

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA

REALIST SYSTEM MAP → SEVEN PADĀRTHAS → FOUR PRAMĀṆAS AND PERCEPTION → INFERENCE ENGINE → CAUSATION AND ATOMISM → SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

REALIST SYSTEM MAP

REALIST SYSTEM MAP

VALID KNOWLEDGE AND ARGUMENT VAIŚEṢIKA

INVENTORY OF REALITY

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA REALISM + PLURALISM + LIBERATION THROUGH TRUTH PRAMĀ

OBJECTS CORRECTLY KNOWN

FALSE NOTIONS REMOVED

FAULTS CEASE KARMA-PRODUCING ACTION CEASES

REBIRTH AND PAIN CEASE

NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth pramā → objects correctly known → false

faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → APAVARGA.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality
- NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth pramā → objects correctly known → false notions removed →

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → APAVARGA.
- NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth pramā → objects correctly known → false notions removed →
- faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → APAVARGA.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Nyāya (the school of logic and valid knowledge) supplies the method of warranted cognition, while Vaiśeṣika (the school of categories and atomism) supplies the realist inventory that the later synthesis explains as one liberation-oriented system.”.

01

STAGE 01

SEVEN PADĀRTHAS

SEVEN PADĀRTHAS

WHATEVER IS NAMEABLE AND KNOWABLE

1 DRAVYA

EARTH, WATER, FIRE, AIR, ĀKĀŚA, TIME, SPACE, SELF, MIND

2 GUṆA

QUALITY; DEPENDS ON SUBSTANCE, DOES NOT ITSELF POSSESS QUALITY/ACTION

3 KARMA

MOTION/ACTION IN A SUBSTANCE

PADĀRTHA: whatever is nameable and knowable

1 DRAVYA: earth, water, fire, air, ākāśa, time, space, self, mind

2 GUṆA: quality; depends on substance, does not itself possess quality/action

3 KARMA: motion/action in a substance

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PADĀRTHA: whatever is nameable and knowable
- 1 DRAVYA: earth, water, fire, air, ākāśa, time, space, self, mind
- 2 GUṆA: quality; depends on substance, does not itself possess quality/action

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 3 KARMA: motion/action in a substance
- 4 SĀMĀNYA: real universal, one-in-many
- 5 VIŚEṢA: ultimate particularity individuating eternal atoms and selves

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- 6 SAMAVĀYA: eternal inherence; whole-parts, universal-particular, quality-substance
- 7 ABHĀVA: absence — prior, posterior, mutual, absolute
- CAUTION: samavāya is not conjunction (samyoga), which is separable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “A padārtha (category or knowable referent) is a distinct kind of reality required to classify what exists, what qualifies or moves it, how it is related, and how its absence is known.”.

02

STAGE 02

FOUR PRAMĀṆAS AND PERCEPTION

FOUR PRAMĀṆAS AND PERCEPTION

SENSE-OBJECT CONTACT

SAVIKALPAKA RECOGNITION

SIGN (LIṄGA/HETU) THROUGH VYĀPTI TO SĀDHYA

KNOWLEDGE THROUGH SIMILARITY AND PRIOR DESCRIPTION

TRUSTWORTHY UTTERANCE, ULTIMATELY ĀPTA TESTIMONY

PERCEPTION TYPES

ORDINARY/ALAUKIKA ALAUKIKA

pratyakṣa: sense-object contact → nirvikalpaka → savikalpaka recognition

anumāna: sign (liṅga/hetu) through vyāpti to sādhya

upamāna: knowledge through similarity and prior description

śabda: trustworthy utterance, ultimately āpta testimony

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

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- anumāna: sign (liṅga/hetu) through vyāpti to sādhya
- upamāna: knowledge through similarity and prior description

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- śabda: trustworthy utterance, ultimately āpta testimony
- PERCEPTION TYPES: external/internal
- ordinary/alaukika alaukika: sāmānyalakṣaṇa, jñānalakṣaṇa, yogaja

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ERROR is mislocation of a real qualifier: anyathākhyāti.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “A pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) is a reliable causal route to true cognition, and Nyāya defends inference by grounding vyāpti (invariable concomitance) through observation, removal of hidden conditions and tarka (hypothetical reductive reasoning).”.

pratyakṣa: sense-object contact → nirvikalpaka → savikalpaka recognition

anumāna: sign (līṅga/hetu) through vyāpti to sādhya

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03

STAGE 03

INFERENCE ENGINE

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INFERENCE FOR ONESELF

DEMONSTRATED TO ANOTHER FIVE MEMBERS

1 PRATIJÑĀ

HILL HAS FIRE

2 HETU

BECAUSE IT HAS SMOKE

3 UDĀHARAṆA

SVĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself

PARĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another five members

1 pratijñā: hill has fire

2 hetu: because it has smoke

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

SVĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself
PARĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another five members
1 pratijñā: hill has fire

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

2 hetu: because it has smoke
3 udāharaṇa: wherever smoke, fire — as kitchen
4 upanaya: hill has such smoke

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

5 nigamana: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + vyāpti + uncontradicted application → conclusion
HETVĀBHĀSA: savyabhicāra, viruddha, satpratipakṣa, asiddha, bādhita.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + vyāpti + uncontradicted application → conclusion.

04

STAGE 04

CAUSATION AND ATOMISM

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EFFECT IS A NEW BEGINNING, NOT PRE-EXISTENT AS EFFECT

SAMAVĀYI (INHERENT)

ASAMAVĀYI (NON-INHERENT)

NIMITTA (EFFICIENT) EARTH/WATER/FIRE/AIR PARAMĀṆU

GROSS COMPOSITE PRALAYA

COMPOSITES DISSOLVE; ETERNAL ATOMS, SELVES, SPACE, TIME REMAIN SRṢṬI

ĪŚVARA ACTIVATES ATOMS ACCORDING TO ADRṢṬA/KARMA

ASATKĀRYAVĀDA / ĀRAMBHAVĀDA: effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyī (inherent)

asamavāyī (non-inherent)

nimitta (efficient) earth/water/fire/air paramāṇu → dyad → triad → gross composite pralaya: composites dissolve

eternal atoms, selves, space, time remain srṣṭi: Īśvara activates atoms according to adrṣṭa/karma

TRAP: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ASATKĀRYAVĀDA / ĀRAMBHAVĀDA: effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyī (inherent)
asamavāyī (non-inherent)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

TRAP: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.
ASATKĀRYAVĀDA / ĀRAMBHAVĀDA: effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyī (inherent)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.

05

STAGE 05

SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

ETERNAL, MANY, ALL-PERVASIVE SUBSTRATE OF COGNITION, DESIRE AND VOLITION

ATOMIC INNER SENSE LINKING SELF TO ONE COGNITION AT

ETERNAL OMNISCIENT EFFICIENT CAUSE; AUTHOR/TEACHER OF VEDA

COORDINATES ATOMS AND KARMIC DESERTS WITHOUT ABOLISHING INDIVIDUAL AGENCY

DOṢA REMOVED

PRAVRṬTI CEASES

KARMA EXHAUSTED

ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

MANAS: atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

ĪŚVARA: eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda

coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed →

classical Nyāya does not define it as Brahman-union.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition
MANAS: atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

ĪŚVARA: eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda
coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed → pravrṭti ceases →

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

classical Nyāya does not define it as Brahman-union.
ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CORE ARGUMENT): “Udayana’s case is strongest cumulatively: the world as effect, atomic arrangement, cosmic support, linguistic convention and moral order converge upon Īśvara (the omniscient Lord) as intelligent efficient—not material—cause.”.

SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

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ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

→

MANAS: atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

→

ĪŚVARA: eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda

→

coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed →

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SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition
- MANAS: atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ĪŚVARA: eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda
- coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed → pravṛtti ceases →

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- classical Nyāya does not define it as Brahman-union.
- ĀTMAN: eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CORE ARGUMENT): “Udayana’s case is strongest cumulatively: the world as effect, atomic arrangement, cosmic support, linguistic convention and moral order converge upon Īśvara (the omniscient Lord) as intelligent efficient—not material—cause.”.

06

STAGE 06

PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON

PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON

UDAYANA ROUTES

KĀRYĀT (EFFECT)

ĀYOJANĀT (COMBINATION)

DHṚTYĀDEḤ (SUPPORT) PADĀT (WORD-USE)

PRATYAYATAḤ (TRUST)

ŚRUTEḤ (VEDA)

VĀKYĀT (SENTENCES) SĀMKNYĀVĪŚEṢĀT (NUMBER)

SĀMKNYĀ: satkāryavāda, prakṛti material cause

BUDDHISM: momentary process

NYĀYA: new effect from atoms

NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- UDAYANA ROUTES: kāryāt (effect)
- āyojanāt (combination)
- dhṛtyādeḥ (support) padāt (word-use)
- pratyayataḥ (trust)
- śruteḥ (Veda)

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- vākyāt (sentences) saṃkhyāviśeṣāt (number)
- adṛṣtāt (moral order)
- OBJECTION: atoms + karma may make God redundant; bodies expose unequal suffering
- REPLY: unconscious atoms/adṛṣṭa cannot intelligently initiate and allocate order
- SĀMKNYĀ: satkāryavāda, prakṛti material cause

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- NYĀYA: new effect from atoms
- BUDDHISM: momentary process
- NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Asatkāryavāda or ārambhavāda (the theory that production begins a previously non-existent effect) preserves novelty, while eternal atoms preserve material continuity through ordered combination.”.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

DEFINE REALIST-PLURALIST SYNTHESIS

LIST SEVEN CATEGORIES WITH RELATIONS

FOUR PRAMĀṆAS

PERCEPTION STAGES

FIVE-MEMBER INFERENCE

ĪŚVARA PROOFS AND OBJECTION

ĀRAMBHAVĀDA + THREE CAUSES

DEFINE realist-pluralist synthesis → list seven categories with relations

→

four pramāṇas → perception stages → five-member inference

→

anyathākhyāti → self/manas → Īśvara proofs and objection

→

ārambhavāda + three causes → atomistic creation cycle

→

apavarga → compare Sāṃkhya/Buddhism → qualified verdict

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE realist-pluralist synthesis → list seven categories with relations
- four pramāṇas → perception stages → five-member inference
- anyathākhyāti → self/manas → Īśvara proofs and objection

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ārambhavāda + three causes → atomistic creation cycle
- apavarga → compare Sāṃkhya/Buddhism → qualified verdict
- VERDICT: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- its pressure points are inference, the leap from order to God, and austere liberation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method:.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY

IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED UNITY AND HISTORICAL QUALIFICATION

THAN ONE UNDIFFERENTIATED DOCTRINE.

THEIR LATER SYNTHESIS IS A DIVISION OF LABOUR

NYAYA CONTRIBUTES PRAMANA THEORY, INFERENCE AND DIALECTIC, WHILE VAISESIKA

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced unity and historical qualification Historically, Nyaya and Vaisesika begin as distinguishable schools rather

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- than one undifferentiated doctrine.
- Their later synthesis is a division of labour: Nyaya contributes pramana theory, inference and dialectic, while Vaisesika contributes
- padarthas, atomism, visesa and samavaya.
- Navya-Nyaya then sharpens the shared analytic vocabulary.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- This system is realist in three linked senses.
- Objects exist independently of cognition
- valid cognition can disclose them
- and even error is explained through misrelation among real factors rather than by reducing the world to appearance.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.